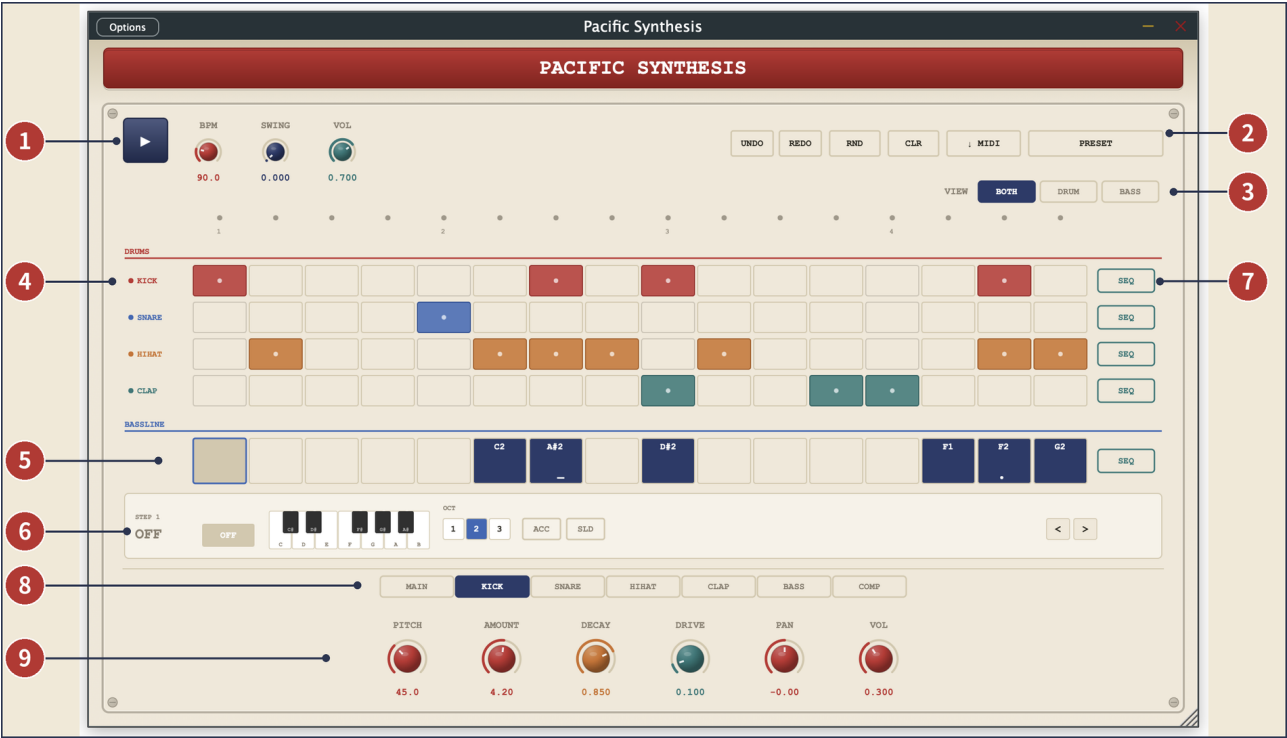


PACIFIC SYNTHESIS

Operation Guide



Thee Coast Machine
v1.0.1 — 2026

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This guide covers **operation only**. For what each knob does to the sound, genre-by-genre settings and tuning order, see the per-voice guides in the bundled **Parameters** folder (Kick / Snare / HiHat / Clap / Bass).

1. The Interface

The window is laid out in four horizontal bands, top to bottom: transport, step grid, step editor, and voice tabs. You set tempo and playback at the top, program the pattern in the middle, and shape the sound at the bottom.

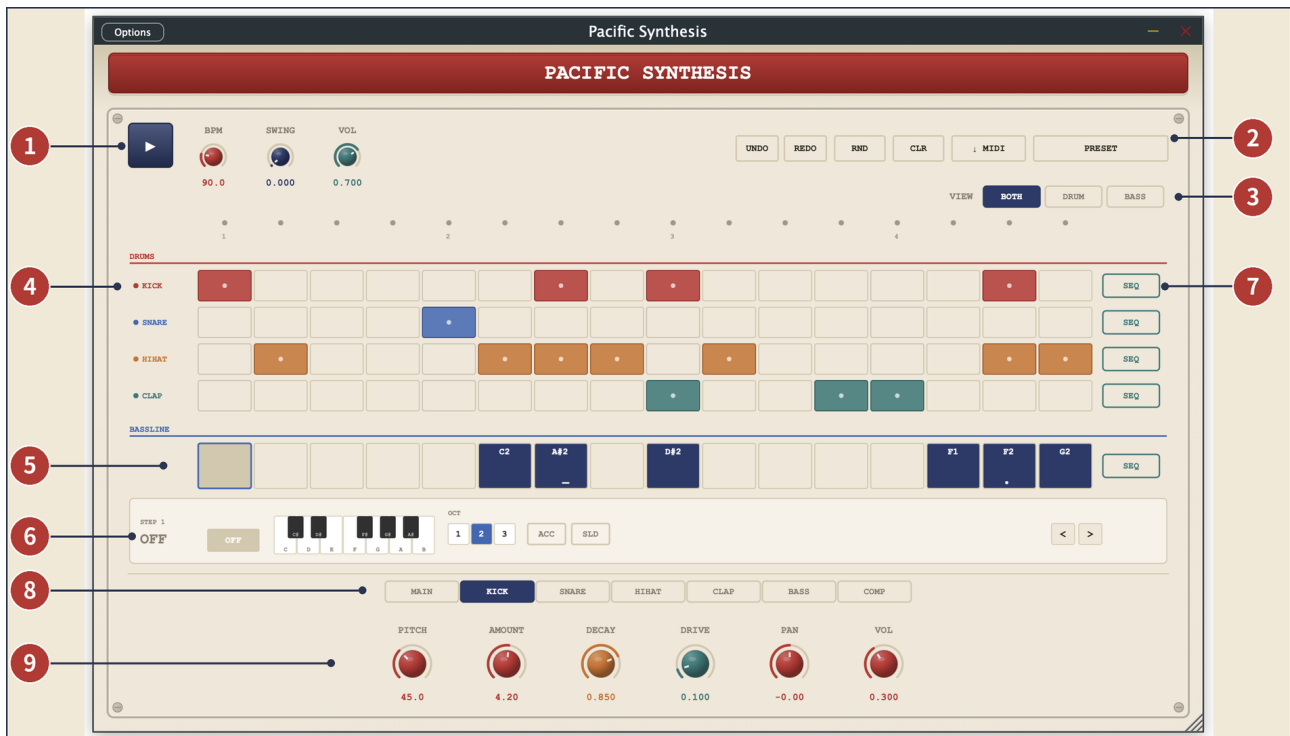


Fig. 1-1 The full interface

No.	Name	Purpose
1	Play button	Start / stop the plug-in's internal sequencer
2	Utilities	UNDO / REDO / RND / CLR / ↓ MIDI / PRESET
3	VIEW	Switch which parts are shown — and heard
4	Drum grid	16 steps for Kick / Snare / HiHat / Clap
5	Bassline	16 steps for the bass, showing note names
6	Step editor	Pitch, ACC and SLD for the selected bass step
7	SEQ buttons	Per-voice source: sequencer / MIDI / muted
8	Voice tabs	MAIN / KICK / SNARE / HIHAT / CLAP / BASS / COMP
9	Knob row	Parameters for the selected tab

2. Making a Sound

The fastest route from a fresh install to audible output.

- 1 Click **PRESET** at the top right, then **Factory Presets** → **Techno** → **01 Techno 135**. This loads a pattern and a sound set together.
- 2 Click ► at the top left. You will hear sound even if your DAW is stopped.
- 3 Click cells in the drum grid to rewrite the pattern. Clicking a lit cell again turns it off.
- 4 Use **UNDO** to step back, **CLR** to wipe the pattern, or **RND** to generate a new one.

► is **internal playback**. It runs independently of your DAW's transport. Once the DAW starts playing, the plug-in follows the host tempo and position automatically — so treat ► as an audition button.

If you hear nothing

- Check each lane's right-hand button reads **SEQ** (OFF means silent).
- Check **VIEW** is set to BOTH — DRUM mutes the bass, BASS mutes the drums.
- Check **VOL** on the MAIN tab and the individual part levels.
- Check the track isn't muted or misrouted in your DAW.

3. Transport

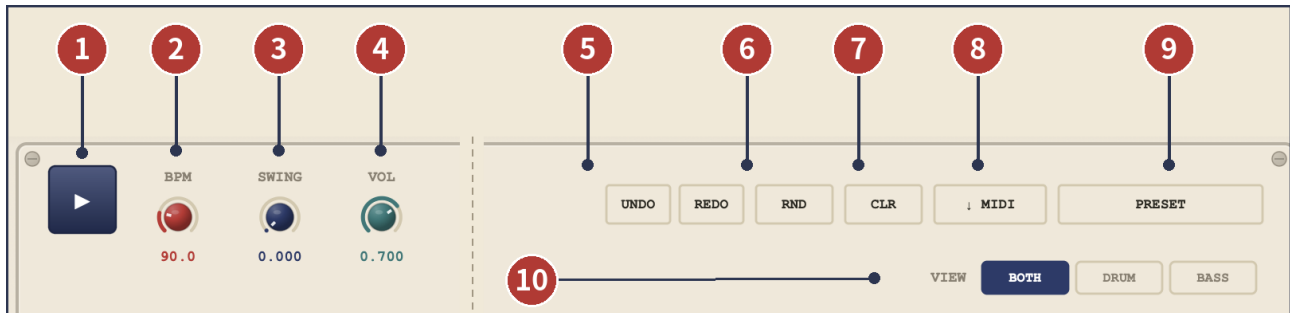


Fig. 3-1 Transport and utility bar

No.	Name	What it does
1	▶ / ■	Start / stop internal playback. Works with the DAW stopped.
2	BPM	Tempo for internal playback. While the host is playing its BPM takes over and the readout follows it.
3	SWING	Delays even-numbered steps for a shuffle feel. 0 = straight.
4	VOL	Master output level for the whole plug-in.
5	UNDO / REDO	Step back or forward through pattern edits and preset loads.
6	RND	Randomise the pattern. Sounds are left untouched.
7	CLR	Clear the pattern. Sounds are left untouched.
8	↓ MIDI	Click to save a MIDI file, drag to drop it straight onto a DAW track.
9	PRESET	Opens the preset menu (chapter 6). The button shows the name of the loaded preset.
10	VIEW	BOTH / DRUM / BASS. This changes what you hear , not just what you see.

UNDO also works with **Cmd+Z (Ctrl+Z on Windows)**. Redo is **Cmd+Shift+Z** or **Cmd+Y**.

4. Programming Patterns

4-1. The drum grid

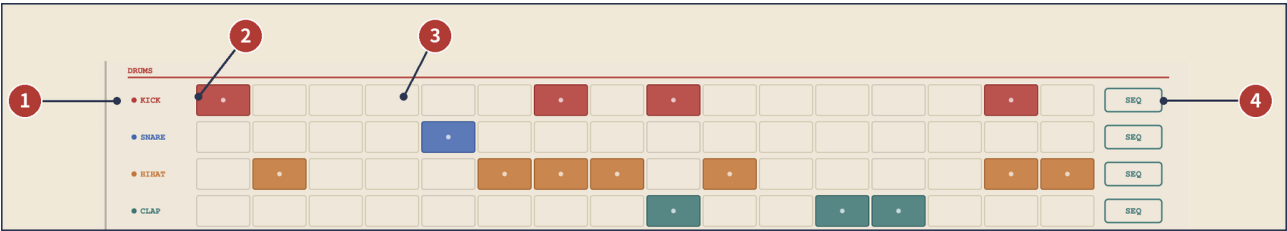


Fig. 4-1 Drum grid

No.	Name	Handling
1	Lane name	Kick / Snare / HiHat / Clap, top to bottom. The dot shows the voice colour.
2	Lit cell	This step will sound. Click to turn it off.
3	Unlit cell	Click to turn it on.
4	SEQ button	Cycles SEQ → MIDI → OFF on each press (see below).

- **Click** — toggles that step on or off.
- **Drag horizontally** — turns on every step you pass over. Dragging never turns steps off; clear them one click at a time.
- The LED row above shows the playback position; 1 / 2 / 3 / 4 mark the beats.

4-2. SEQ / MIDI / OFF — where each voice gets its notes

The button at the right of each lane is a three-way toggle that decides **what triggers that voice**. Each press advances to the next state.

Label	Behaviour
SEQ	Played by the built-in 16-step sequencer (default). In this state incoming MIDI notes are ignored .
MIDI	The sequencer is bypassed for this voice; it responds only to MIDI notes from the DAW. Use this to play it from a keyboard or piano roll.
OFF	The voice is muted. The pattern is preserved.

This is the single most important control to understand. If notes drawn in your DAW's piano roll produce no sound, the lane is almost certainly still set to SEQ. Switch it to **MIDI**.

4-3. The bassline

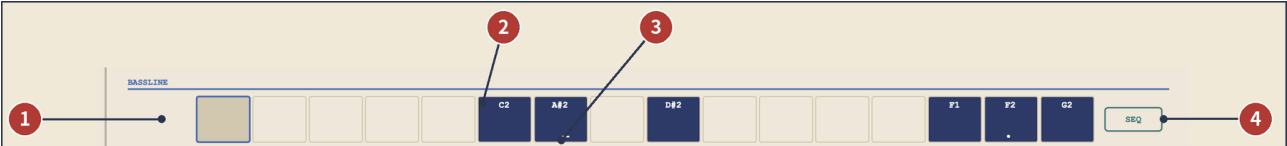


Fig. 4-2 Bassline row

No.	Name	Handling
1	Selected step	The blue outline marks the step the editor below edits.
2	Programmed note	The cell displays the note name, e.g. C2.
3	SLD / ACC marks	— at the bottom of a cell means slide, • means accent.
4	SEQ button	Note source for the bass (SEQ / MIDI / OFF).

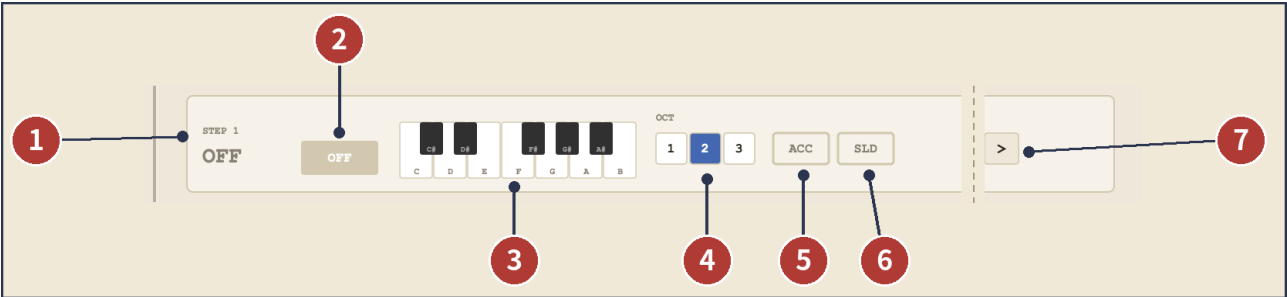


Fig. 4-3 Step editor (the dashed break omits empty space)

No.	Name	Handling
1	Step readout	The selected step number and its note (or OFF).
2	ON / OFF	Toggles the step between sounding and rest.
3	Keyboard	Click a key to set the pitch. This also turns the step on.
4	OCT	Choose octave 1, 2 or 3.
5	ACC	Accent, scaled by ACCENT on the BASS tab.
6	SLD	Slides the pitch into the next step — the 303 glide.
7	< >	Move the selection one step back or forward.

Bass cells behave differently from drum cells. The first click only **selects** the step — nothing sounds yet. Clicking an **already-selected** cell toggles it on or off. To enter a pitch, select the cell and then click the keyboard below.

4-4. Narrowing the grid with VIEW

VIEW at the top right changes both what the grid shows and what sounds. Use DRUM when you want to concentrate on the beat, and BASS when you want to hear the bassline on its own.

Setting	Shows	Sounds
BOTH	Drums + bass	Both (default)
DRUM	Drums only	Bass muted
BASS	Bass only	Drums muted

5. Shaping the Sound

The tabs at the bottom of the window choose which voice you are editing. Pressing a tab replaces the entire knob row beneath it.

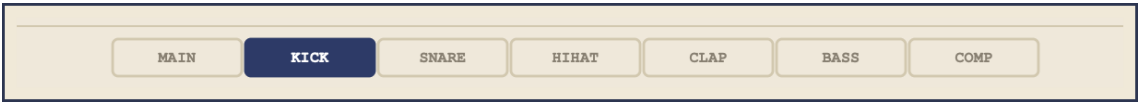


Fig. 5-1 Voice tabs

Working with knobs

Action	Result
Drag vertically or horizontally	Change the value. Move slowly for fine adjustment.
Double-click	Reset to the default value.
Right-click (Ctrl-click on Mac)	Opens the MIDI Learn menu . See chapter 9.
Hover	A tooltip explains the parameter.

5-1. MAIN — mix and effects

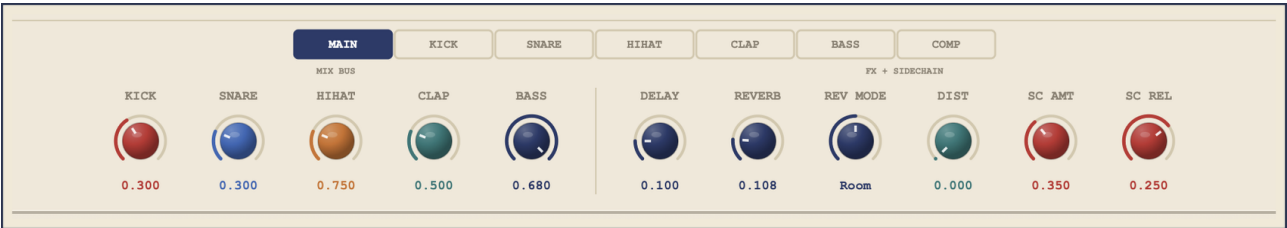


Fig. 5-2 MAIN tab

The left half sets the balance between parts; the right half holds the effects and sidechain. DELAY / REVERB / DIST are send amounts, REV MODE switches between Plate / Room / Hall, and SC AMT / SC REL set how deeply and for how long the kick ducks the bass.

5-2. Per-voice tabs

KICK, SNARE, HIHAT, CLAP and BASS each present their own set of knobs. Knob colours follow the same colour coding as the rest of the interface.



Fig. 5-3 KICK



Fig. 5-4 SNARE

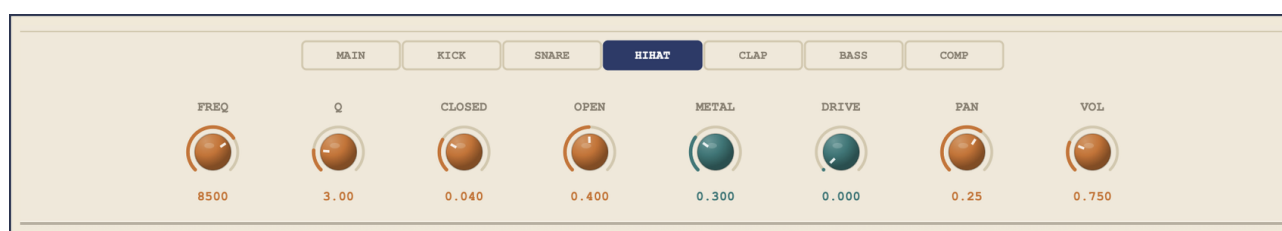


Fig. 5-5 HIHAT



Fig. 5-6 CLAP



Fig. 5-7 BASS

What each value does to the sound, genre-specific starting points and what to reach for when a sound won't sit are all covered in the **per-voice guides in the Parameters folder**.

5-3. COMP — master bus compressor



Fig. 5-8 COMP

A VCA-style compressor across the whole output. Setting THRESH to 0.0 dB effectively bypasses it.

6. Presets

The **PRESET** button at the top right opens the menu.

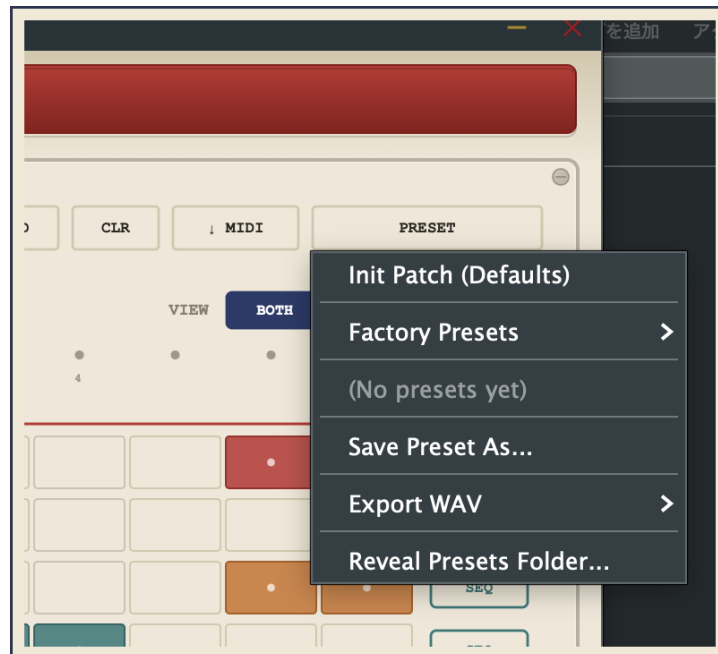


Fig. 6-1 Preset menu

Item	What it does
Init Patch (Defaults)	Returns every parameter to its default.
Factory Presets	Built-in sounds, grouped into genre submenus (Machines / House / Techno / Acid / Dub / DnB / Breaks / IDM / Chill and more).
(user preset list)	Presets you have saved. Shows "(No presets yet)" when empty.
Save Preset As...	Save under a new name.
Save (overwrite ...)	Overwrite the currently loaded preset.
Delete ...	Delete the currently loaded preset.
Export WAV	Render the pattern to audio (chapter 7).
Reveal Presets Folder...	Open the presets folder in Finder / Explorer.

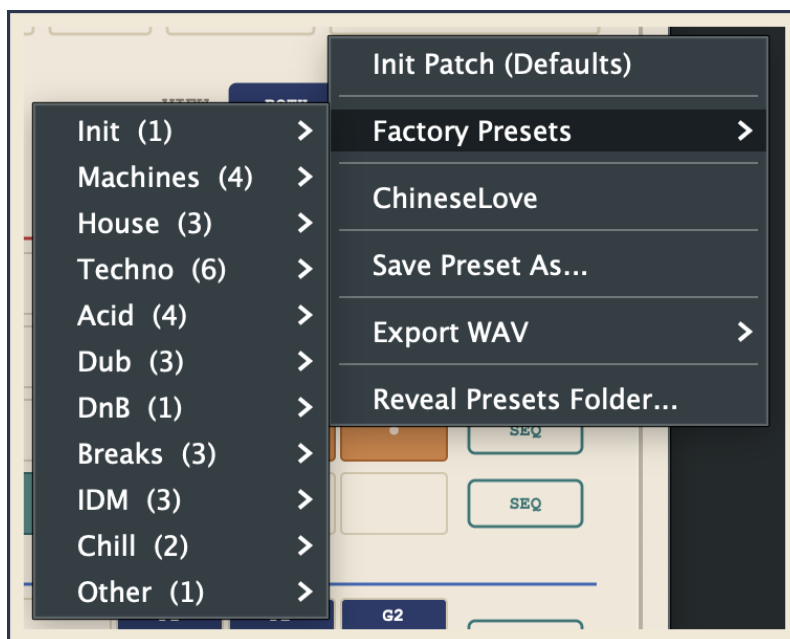


Fig. 6-2 Factory preset categories (counts in brackets, 31 total)

Pick a category to see the presets inside. Loading a preset swaps **the sound and the pattern together**, which makes this the quickest way to find a starting point for a track.

Presets live in `~/Documents/Pacific Synthesis/Presets/` as `.preset` files — copy them to move your sounds between machines. A preset stores **both the sound and the pattern**.

7. Exporting

7-1. MIDI export

The ↓ **MIDI** button gets your pattern out as MIDI.

Action	Result
Click	Opens a save dialog and writes a MIDI file (drums and bass together in one file).
Drag	Hold the button and drop onto a DAW track to create a MIDI clip in place.

The note numbers used are listed in chapter 8.

7-2. WAV export

Export WAV in the PRESET menu renders the current pattern to audio files.

Menu	What you get
2MIX	The full mix as a single stereo WAV.
Stems (5 files)	Kick, Snare, HiHat, Clap and Bass as separate files. All five share one normalisation scale , so lining them up in a DAW reproduces the original balance exactly.

Both offer lengths of **1, 2, 4 or 8 bars**. Choose an output folder and a progress window renders it in the background.

Files are named `<preset>_<bpm>_<bars>_mix.wav`, or with the part name in place of `mix`.

8. Using It in a DAW

8-1. Tempo and playback

Situation	Tempo	Playback
▶ pressed with the DAW stopped	The BPM knob	The internal sequencer runs on its own
The DAW is playing	Host BPM	Locked to the host position

The BPM readout switches to the host value while the DAW plays, and tempo-synced delay follows it too.

8-2. Playing it from the DAW

For any voice you want to play from a piano roll or keyboard, **switch that lane's SEQ button to MIDI**. While it reads SEQ, incoming notes are ignored.

The MIDI channel decides whether notes reach the drums or the bass.

MIDI channel	Routing
ch 10	The note numbers below trigger drums. Other notes do nothing.
any other channel	Every note is sent to the bass , regardless of note number.

Voice	Low (GM)	High	Notes
Kick	C1 (36)	C5 (84)	Also fires the sidechain
Snare	D1 (38)	D5 (86)	
Clap	D#1 (39)	D#5 (87)	
HiHat (Closed)	F#1 (42)	F#5 (90)	
HiHat (Open)	A#1 (46)	G#5 (92)	Chokes the closed hat

Note names assume **Middle C = C3 = MIDI 60** (Yamaha / Studio One / Ableton convention). DAWs that call MIDI 48 "C3", such as Logic Pro, will show these an octave away — go by the **note numbers in brackets**.

- **Velocity 100 or above** accents the bass.
- Bass MIDI input is **polyphonic** — chords play as chords, and if CHORD on the BASS tab is set to anything but Off, each note gets its own harmony stack.
- To drive drums and bass from MIDI at the same time, put the drums on channel 10 and the bass on any other channel.

9. Shortcuts & Tips

9-1. Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
Cmd + Z / Ctrl + Z	Undo
Cmd + Shift + Z / Ctrl + Shift + Z	Redo
Cmd + Y / Ctrl + Y	Redo (Windows style)

9-2. MIDI Learn — mapping knobs to a controller

Right-click any knob (Control-click on Mac) to open the MIDI CC assignment menu.

- 1 Right-click the knob and choose **Learn MIDI CC...**
- 2 Move a knob or fader on your controller. The first CC that arrives is assigned automatically.
- 3 To remove it, right-click the same knob and choose **Clear MIDI mapping**. To reassign, use **Re-learn MIDI CC**.

To leave learn mode without assigning anything, right-click again and choose **Cancel MIDI Learn**.

9-3. Resizing the window

Drag the hatched corner at the bottom right to resize. The aspect ratio is fixed and the range is **0.7×** to **2.0×** the default size — useful when the text is small on a high-resolution display.

9-4. Working faster

- **Hit RND, keep what you like, fix the rest.** UNDO goes back as many steps as you need.
- **Drag horizontally** across the drum grid to lay down 16th-note runs in one gesture — ideal for hats.
- For the bass, step through with **< >** and play the keyboard instead of moving the mouse back and forth.
- Presets store **the pattern too**, so save one per song idea and recall it later.

10. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause and fix
No sound at all	Check that no lane is set to OFF . VIEW set to DRUM or BASS mutes the other half. Check VOL on the MAIN tab and the part levels.
Silent from the DAW, but ► works	That lane is still on SEQ . Switch it to MIDI .
Drum notes play the bass instead	The MIDI channel isn't 10. Every note on any other channel goes to the bass.
Clicking a bass cell doesn't turn it on	The first click only selects. Click again , or set a pitch on the keyboard below.
Dragging won't erase cells	By design. Dragging only turns steps on — clear them with individual clicks.
The BPM knob does nothing	The host tempo wins while the DAW is playing. Stop the DAW, or change the tempo there.
The plug-in doesn't appear in the DAW	Confirm the install location and force a rescan in the plug-in manager. Logic Pro does not load VST3 — use the .component (AU).
The sound distorts	Lower VOL on MAIN and raise THRESH on the COMP tab (0.0 dB bypasses it). Check DRIVE on the individual parts too.

Going Further

Detailed parameter explanations, genre-specific settings and a tuning order for each voice are in the per-voice guides in the bundled **Documentation / Parameters** folder.

- Pacific_Synthesis_Kick_Guide.pdf
- Pacific_Synthesis_Snare_Guide.pdf
- Pacific_Synthesis_HiHat_Guide.pdf
- Pacific_Synthesis_Clap_Guide.pdf
- Pacific_Synthesis_Bass_Guide.pdf

Pacific Synthesis is free and open source under the AGPLv3.

github.com/theclash006-design/PacificSynthesis

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